

Never cut through columns. They look like walls when they're cut, and that can lead to confusion.

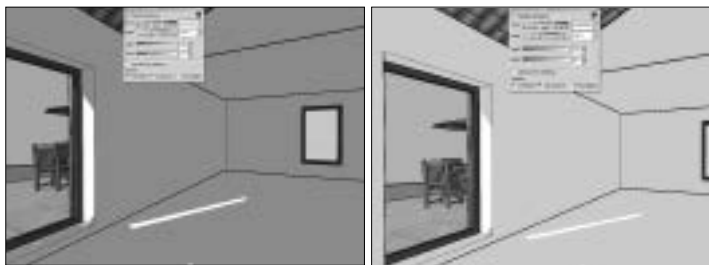
Always cut through stairs or elevators—you audience will appreciate knowing where the access to the next storey is.

9.2.3 Indoor Lighting Worries

In chapter 7, you might have noticed that the lighting inside the villa is rather dull, and can make for a boring walkthrough. If you're in a building that has multiple storeys, you obviously can't delete the ceiling to let the light in...

Open the Shadows dialog (Window > Shadows) and drag the Dark slider towards white to brighten up the indoors a little.

If you're working with a single-storey building and don't want to delete the roof, you can have it not cast any shadows. Select the ceiling (or roof, as the case may be), right-click on it and choose Entity Info. Un-check the box against Cast Shadows. You should have a much brighter indoor scene now.



A little less darkness never hurts

9.2.4 The Steven Spielberg Effect

This technique was popularised by Spielberg in *Jaws*, and has been much abused since—which is why we have no qualms abusing it a bit more. It's purely for fun, so you could use this to spice up a boring presentation. This works best if your camera is set up close to the ground.

Set up your scene as in the screenshot. The two boxes will serve as a reference. Now set up your camera in such a way that the two boxes are at the edges of your view. Tweak till you're sat-